

Being Kind to Myself

20–25 min · Week 11 · PPRA · Counselor Briefed

OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that they deserve the same kindness they give a friend, and practise turning kind words inward toward themselves.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management · self-compassion (adapted from Dr. Kristin Neff's framework)
VOCABULARY	self-compassion · kindness · good friend · common humanity · notice the feeling
MATERIALS	Sammy puppet · Three Parts of Being Kind to Yourself anchor chart · card-fold paper for the kind message

SAFETY CHECK

PPRA-designated lesson. Family notification confirmed. Standard opt-out protocols apply. See Section 4, Legal & Clinical Compliance. Counselor briefed in advance. Counselor on standby — reachable same-day. During the kind-message activity, some students who are heavily critical of themselves may become quietly emotional. This is healthy — they may be receiving permission they have never been given. Do not draw class attention. Acknowledge privately.

OPENING REVIEW · 1–2 MIN

Show the Three-Part Real Sorry chart. "Last lesson: how to apologize to others. Today: a different question. When WE make a mistake — how do we talk to OURSELVES?*"

SAMMY · KIND COACH VOICE

"I have a question that surprised me. If a friend made a mistake — I would be kind to them. But when I make a mistake — I am MEAN to myself. Why?"

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 4

1

The Friend Test

5 MIN

Pose the test: "Imagine your best friend made a mistake. They feel terrible. What would you SAY to them?" Take 3–4 student responses. Write the words on chart paper. Then ask: "Would you say those same words to YOURSELF?*"

2

Part One — Self-Kindness

4 MIN

Build the first part: "When YOU make a mistake — talk to yourself like you would talk to a good friend. 'I care about you. This is hard. You are doing your best.' Speak to yourself with care — not with cruelty.**"